STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-6218
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED **03/29/18**	DATE REVISED	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT LESS LETHAL SHOTGUNS	CROSS REFERENCE G-6100 USE OF FORCE G-6110 USE OF FORCE REPORTING REQUIREMENTS			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for issuing and deploying the less lethal shotgun system.

II. Policy:

The less lethal shotgun is a less-lethal impact munitions weapon system that may be used in a variety of law enforcement situations where there is need to safely control non-compliant individuals. Each less-lethal shotgun will be a dedicated weapons system and will be clearly marked with less-lethal orange on the stock and forearm of the weapon for easy identification. The less-lethal shotgun and all less-lethal impact munition rounds will be stored separate from all other shotgun armament or rounds. No live shotgun rounds will ever be loaded into a less-lethal shotgun under any circumstances.

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office utilizes one type of less-lethal impact round in their less-lethal shotguns:

- The Drag Stabilized 12-Gauge Bean Bag Round is a translucent 12-Gauge shell loaded with a 40-Gram tear shaped bag made from a cotton and ballistic material blend and filled with #9 shot. This design utilizes four stabilizing tails and utilizes smokeless powder as the propellant. This round has a velocity of 270 fps with a maximum effective range of 75 feet. The Drag Stabilized 12-Gauge Round is a high-energy munition.

Deputies of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall use the less-lethal shotgun system only in accordance with established use of force policies and procedures (see G-6100 Use of Force). Only those less-lethal shotguns approved by the Sheriff shall be utilized. Only less-lethal shotguns approved and maintained by the Sheriff's Office shall be used.

III. Procedures:

A. Training: Only trained and certified deputies shall carry or utilize a less lethal shotgun. Topics covered during training shall include, but are not limited to, proper deployment, contiguous fire, storage and maintenance, proper munitions identification, and use of lethal cover

1. A certified instructor recognized by the manufacturer shall conduct training.

2. Deputies shall recertify annually.

3. The Training Sergeant shall maintain a list of all deputies currently certified in the use of the less lethal shotgun.

B. Storage and Maintenance:

1. Less-lethal shotgun systems shall only be stored in a sergeant's assigned road patrol vehicle, the designated courthouse security office weapons locker, the less-lethal locker in the road patrol storage room, the ESU van, or the ESU storage room. The less-lethal shotgun and all less-lethal impact munition rounds will be stored separate from all other shotgun armament or live rounds.

2. Any deputy that is assigned a less-lethal shotgun and specialized impact rounds shall not be assigned or carry a standard department shotgun or live ammunition.

3. While in transport, the less-lethal shotgun system shall be stored in a case or in the mounted shotgun rack in the interior of a Sheriff's Office vehicle.

4. All Less-lethal shotguns will be stored with the chamber and magazine tube empty. The specialized impact rounds will be stored in the side saddle of the shotgun. The deputy who deploys the less-lethal shotgun shall visually identify and confirm they are loading less-lethal rounds from the side saddle.

5. In the event the less-lethal shotgun system is discharged during an incident the on-duty supervisor is responsible for notifying a firearms instructor of its use and any needed repairs. A less-lethal instructor shall be notified for re-stocking of supplies that may be required.

6. Maintenance of less-lethal shotgun systems shall be completed by a certified shotgun armorer. The certified shotgun armorer shall then return the less-lethal shotgun to a less-lethal instructor. A less-lethal instructor will then confirm that the weapon has only specialized impact rounds and return the weapon to the deputy.

C. **Deployment:** The less-lethal shotgun system shall be deployed in accordance with all Sheriff's Office training standards, policies and procedures. Less-lethal shotgun systems shall only be deployed when justified according to the use of force policy (see G-6100 Use of Force). The less lethal shotgun is considered an intermediate weapon.

1. All Specialty impact rounds are not fundamentally designed to cause serious bodily injury or death. However, under certain circumstances, these munitions can and have the potential to cause serious injury or death.

2. Lethal cover will always be used when deploying a less-lethal shotgun system

3. When tactically feasible, verbal commands shall be given prior to, during and after the deployment of a less-lethal shotgun system.

4. The less-lethal shotgun system may be used to de-escalate potentially dangerous situations where lesser force options would likely be ineffective and where deadly force may not be appropriate. These situations may include"

a) Barricade/hostage incidents.
b) Suicidal persons.
c) Violent or actively aggressive subjects that may cause injury.
d) Cell extractions.
e) Animal control.

5. Prior to deploying the less-lethal shotgun system, the deputy shall:

a) Consider the safety of innocent by-standers, other deputies, and the subject.
b) Considered the exhibited level of threat, distance in relation to the target, and available target areas.
c) Assign a deadly force cover deputy.
d) Prepare an arrest plan, when possible, as the effects of the less-lethal shotgun system may only be temporary.
e) When tactically feasible, announce to other deputies on scene that less-lethal shotgun system projectiles are about to be deployed.
f) Give loud verbal commands to the subject to obey the deputy's directions.

6. When deploying the less-lethal shotgun system, the manufacturer's general recommended minimum range for the Drag Stabilized 12-Gauge Bean Bag Round is twenty (20) feet. The manufacturer's general recommended maximum effective range for the Drag Stabilized 12-Gauge Bean Bag Round is seventy-five (75).

7. Less-lethal shotgun systems are less-lethal and not non-lethal. When deploying the less-lethal shotgun, the goal is to resolve a potentially violent situation with a minimal amount of force and the lease likelihood of injury to all involve parties. The primary target areas are:

a) Zone 1* -Buttocks, thigh, calf, excluding the groin.
*Zone 1 should be considered first due to lower potential for injury.

b) Zone 2* -Abdominal area.

c) Zone 3* –Chest (center mass, spine, head, and neck).
*Zone 3 should only be considered when the level of threat escalates to deadly force

*Note –The shoulders and arms are primarily skeletal areas. Because of the mobility of the shoulders and arms there is a greater potential to miss and unintentionally strike another zone. Careful consideration should be given be aiming for the shoulders and arms.

D. Post Deployment:

1. Any deputy deploying a less-lethal shotgun system (including negligent discharges) shall immediately notify his or her supervisor. The supervisor shall respond to the scene.

2. The supervisor shall notify the on-duty watch commander or ADC.

3. The on-scene supervisor shall photograph the subject and the less-lethal shotgun impact areas as well as any secondary injuries resulting from the use of the less-lethal shotgun system.

4. After the deployment of a less-lethal shotgun, any person struck with specialty impact round shall be administered any necessary first aid, after being secured. EMS shall also be summoned to render medical aid as soon as tactically possible. The medical service who responds shall transport the party to an emergency room to be medically cleared.

5. If the subject was struck by a less-lethal shotgun round in the head, neck, spine or groin area, or a secondary injury requires hospitalization, the on-scene supervisor shall request the on-call investigator respond.

E. Reporting: With the exception of training, deputies shall document all uses of the less-lethal shotgun system (including negligent discharges) in accordance with

Sheriff's Office use of force reporting requirements (see G-6110 Use of Force Reporting Requirements).

1. On all operational deployments, the Use of Force Report form shall include:

- **a)** A brief description of the incident.
- **b)** The number of less-lethal shotgun rounds fired at the subject and where those rounds impacted the subject's body, if known.
- **c)** The distance the deputy was from the subject.
- **d)** Medical treatment provided to the subject.
- **e)** A description of the subject's actions after being struck with the less-lethal shotgun system.
- **f)** A description of any injuries sustained by the subject including secondary injuries that may have occurred.

2. If the less-lethal shotgun system is deployed on an animal, the deputy shall complete an information report.

3. Deputies negligently discharging a less-lethal shotgun system shall complete an information report.